

NON-FINITES

(INFINITIVES, PARTICIPLES, GERUNDS)

There are three kinds of Non-Finites:

- (i) Infinitives
- (ii) Participle
- (iii) Gerund

(i) *Infinitive* :

'Infinitives' in form is 'to + I form of verb' in active voice and 'to be + III form of verb' in passive voice.

It is time to ring the *bell*. (Active)

It is time for the *bell* to be rung. (Passive)

'Infinitives' are of two kinds :

- 1. Simple Infinitives
- 2. Gerundial Infinitives or Adverb Infinitives

1. Simple Infinitives are used as :

- (a) Subject of a verb:

To err is human.

- (b) Object of a verb:

I want **to go** there.

- (c) Complement of a verb:

My ambition is **to become** a lawyer.

- (d) Object of a Preposition:

He is about **to leave** for Mumbai.

2. Gerundial Infinitives are used :

- (a) to express purpose:

I went to Delhi **to meet** my uncle.

- (b) to qualify an adjective:

This apple is sweet **to taste**.

(c) to qualify a noun:

This house is **to let**.

As gerundial infinitives sometimes act as adverbs, they are called **Adverb Infinitives**.

‘To + I form of verb’ is the Present to form of infinitive.

‘To have + III form of verb’ is the Perfect form of infinitive.

But the Perfect form is used after the past tense of a finite verb.

He was expected to **have solved** the sums.

(ii) Participle :

A Participle is a verbal form used as an adjective and sometimes as an adverb. It is also used as part of an adverb phrase:

He gave me a *broken* slate.

This book is interesting.

Having burnt his finger, he moved away from the fire.

Thus Participles are of three kinds:

(i) The Present Participle

(ii) The Past Participle

(iii) The Perfect Participle

1. The Present Participle is formed by adding 'ing' to the I form of verb : e.g. eating, writing, singing, sleeping etc.

The news is *alarming*.

Don't disturb a *sleeping* baby.

2. The Past Participle is the third form of verb : e.g. burnt, damaged etc.

A *burnt* child dreads fire.

I found my *lost* book.

3. The Perfect Participle is formed by adding *having* or *having been* (in the Passive form) before the Past Participle:

Having finished our work, we went to the garden.

The *sun having set*, they stopped working.

(iii) Gerund :

A Gerund ends in ‘ing’ (I form of verb + ing). It has the form of a noun and a verb. It is a verb in form but a noun in function. Both the Gerund and the Present Participle have the same form. But the former is used as a noun, while the latter is used as an *adjective*.

As both the Gerund and the Infinitive have the force of a noun and a verb, in many sentences either of them can be used without any special difference in meaning, as :

Teach me to *swim*.

OR

Teach me *swimming*.

To give is better than to *receive*.

OR

Giving is better than *receiving*.

Use of Gerund :

- (a) Subject of a verb :

Walking is a good exercise.

Dancing is an art.

- (b) Object of a verb :

Give up *drinking*.

She likes *dancing*.

- (c) Object of a preposition :

I am fond of *singing*.

- (d) Complement of a verb

I like **sleeping** in the afternoon.

Exercises for Practice

Exercise 1

- (a) Fill in the blanks selecting suitable to-infinitives from the following list:

(to see, to implement, to do, to announce, to show, to join, to let, to waste, to play, to do, to go, to solve, to post, to ask, to remember)

1. It is time
2. That was a sight
3. The judge has a judgement
4. That is something
5. I have a new plan
6. I have a nice picture
7. Have you any plan the college?
8. I have some questions you.
9. Have you any work?
10. I have a house
11. She has no problem

12. I have no time
13. Do you have any letters ?
14. He has some home-work
15. Bedi has a match on Sunday.

(b) *Frame seven meaningful sentences from the table below:*

I have	some letters	to ask you
	some homework	to waste
	some good news	to play on Sunday
	a question	to show you
	some pictures	to do
	a match	to tell you
	no time	to post

Exercise 2

Fill in the blanks with the-ing form (Present Participle form) as Gerund of the following verbs:

(a) *(smoke, look, spit, swim, read, wait, go, read, eat, see)*

1. is a very good exercise.
2. No in this compartment.
3. French is easier than to speak it.
4. after children requires patience.
5. between meals is bad.
6. No
7. He insisted on her.
8. I am quite used to in queues.
9. Do you feel like for a swim?
10. I am looking forward to that book.

(b) *(travel, talk, work, walk, ride, see, wait, steal, drop, smoke, cut) :*

1. He is used to at night.
2. Try to avoid in the rush hour.
3. There's nothing here worth
4. Stop
5. Would you mind a moment?
6. He prefers to
7. The grass needs
8. I don't allow here.
9. I heard the coin
10. I caught him my apples.

Exercise 3

Put the -ing forms (Participles) of the following Verbs in the blanks in the following sentences:

(please, write, rise, sun, tire, drip, bore, work, grow, amuse)

1. I caught a dog.
2. It was a sight.
3. We had a journey.
4. Give him a pad.
5. crops need care.
6. I do not like taps.
7. Did you see the flame?
8. It was a play.
9. We had an talk.
10. The government is looking after the classes.

Exercise 4

Given below are some pairs of sentences, Combine them into single sentences, using the Participle Phrases:

1. I saw a thief.
He was running away towards the station.
2. You can see the child.
She is sleeping peacefully.
3. His brother came home.
He brought an English wife with him.
4. Kindly give something to the poor beggar.
He is crying for alms.
5. The prince slept soundly.
He dreamt of his bright future.
6. My father came back home.
He brought some fruit for us.
7. Ram killed the witness.
He was giving a statement.
8. A police officer came to my house today.
He brought my missing bicycle with him.
9. I can hear my son.
He is saying prayers.

10. Could you bring me a pen?
It is lying on the shelf.

Exercise 5

Fill in the blanks with correct Past Participle form of the given verbs :

(wound, cook, burn, break, write, build, rot, lose, unlock, fade, close, paint, translate, finish, fail)

1. I got my house
2. He got the book
3. The soldier was taken to the hospital.
4. The overseer is getting this house
5. The rose was thrown out.
6. You must get the room
7. The food got spoilt.
8. Give a statement.
9. A child dreads the fire.
10. This college does not admit students.
11. He died of a heart.
12. The officer wants this work by today.
13. Who likes vegetables?
14. That lady found her purse.
15. I found all the doors

Exercise 6

Combine the following sentences using Participles or Gerunds or Infinitives :

1. I made a journey to Mumbai yesterday. I went there to get the best financial advice.
2. Your parcel never reached me. It had been addressed to the wrong place.
3. Turn to the right. You will find the office.
4. He drew his sword. He rushed at the king.
5. It was my purse. It had been lost.
6. He made a promise. He kept it also.
7. One must serve twenty years. After that one can retire.
8. He said he would come today. I was pleased at this.
9. I promise to help you in times of need. You can rely on this.
10. She was praised by all. She grew proud.